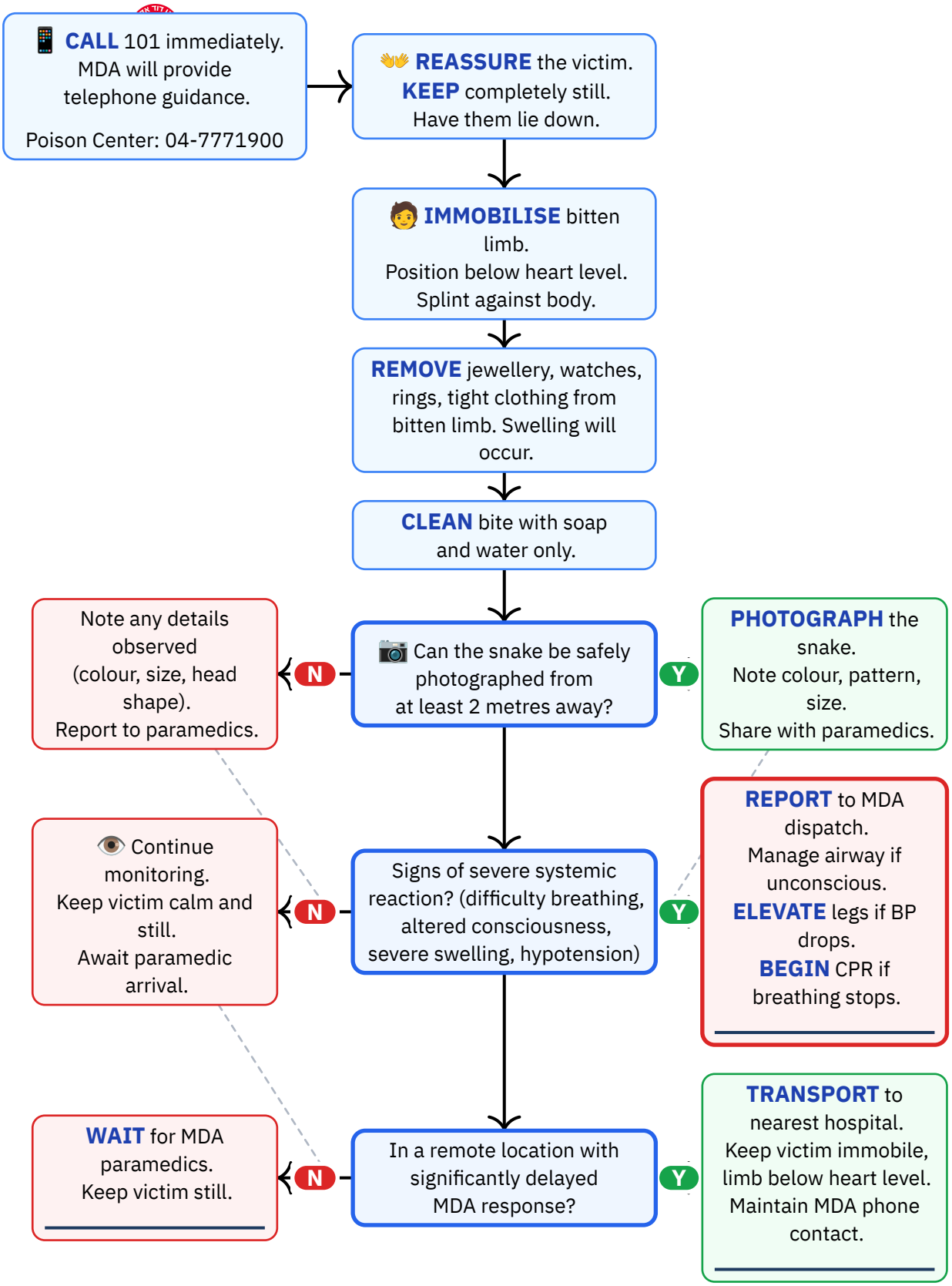

Personal reference only — not medical advice

Daniel Rosehill · share with attribution

Reference Notes

DO NOT:

- ✕ **Do NOT apply a tourniquet** – it traps venom locally and causes severe tissue damage.
- ✕ **Do NOT suck the venom** out of the wound – this is ineffective and dangerous.
- ✕ **Do NOT cut or incise** the bite area – increases infection risk and does not help remove venom.
- ✕ **Do NOT cool or apply ice** to the bite area – can worsen tissue damage.
- ✕ **Do NOT give food or drink** – may complicate hospital treatment.
- ✕ **Do NOT induce vomiting.**
- ✕ **Do NOT give aspirin, ibuprofen, or naproxen** – viper venom is often anticoagulant.
- ✕ **Do NOT use alcohol-based disinfectants** on the wound.
- ✕ **Do NOT attempt to catch or kill the snake** – protected under Israeli law; risks additional bites.
- ✕ **Do NOT allow the victim to walk** or move the bitten limb – movement accelerates venom circulation.

Equipment needed:

— Splint or improvised immobilisation material
— Soap and clean water for wound cleaning
— Phone or camera to photograph the snake

Medically Dangerous Snakes in Israel

Species	Hebrew Name	Antivenom
Daboia palaestinae (Palestine viper)	צפע ארצישראלי	Available (Kamada Ltd.)
Echis coloratus (Painted saw-scaled viper)	אפעה צבעונית	Available (Kamada Ltd.)
Atractaspis engaddensis (Israeli mole viper)	שחור עין גדי	Not available

Peak season: spring/summer. Israel Poison Information Center: 04-7771900 (24/7, Rambam Hospital, Haifa)

Personal reference only — not medical advice
Daniel Rosehill · share with attribution

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Snake	נחש	na-KHASH
Snakebite	הכשת נחש	ha-ka-SHAT na-KHASH
Venom / poison	ארס	E-res
Swelling	נפיחות	ne-fi-KHUT
Splint	סד	SAD
Lie down	לשכב	lish-KAV
Calm down	להירגע	le-hi-ra-GE-a
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
I was bitten by a snake	ננשכתי על ידי נחש	ni-SHAKH-ti al ye-DEI na-KHASH

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — How to Treat a Snake Bite
URL: https://www.mdais.org/101/snake-bite
Publication date: Standing public guidance
Imported: 2026-03-15 · **Last verified:** 2026-03-15

Personal reference only — not medical advice
Daniel Rosehill · share with attribution